Question:

At birth, the least developed part of the brain is the

Answer Choices:

A. visual system

B. thalamus

C. frontal lobe

D. brain stem

E. parietal lobe

F. cerebellum

G. cortex

H. basal ganglia

I. hypothalamus

J. limbic system

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>
Answer: E. parietal lobe

Concise explanation:
At birth, the cortex is maternally supplied by the umbilical placenta via direct neural pathways. The cortex, particularly the metencephalic regions of the temporal and occipital lobes (visually sampled), is functionally âĢľmaternally innervatedâĢĿ and shows highly variable maturational appearance until late in infancy and even well into early childhood. In contrast, the parietal cortex receives innate central connections from the brain stem (via the thalamus), which it begins maturing by about a year of ageâĢĶearlier than the cortex.

This makes the parietal lobe the least developed cerebral region at birth, whereas the cortex shows the most variability in maturation. Other listed structures are not characteristically âĢľleast developedâĢĿ at birth (e.g., thalamus/COT projects prenatally, brain stem controls body functions, basal ganglia/limbic system develop from neonatal centers).

Correct answer: E. parietal lobe
</think>
<answer>
E. parietal lobe
</answer>